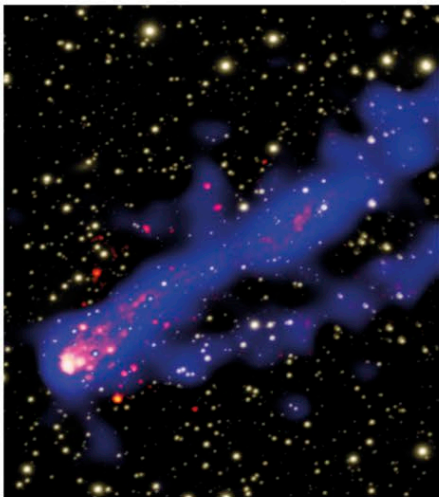


NORMA

THE SET SQUARE

THIS IS A SMALL CONSTELLATION THAT WAS ONLY CREATED IN THE EARLY 1750s, AND LATER REDUCED IN SIZE. IT LIES ON THE PATH OF THE MILKY WAY AND IS RICH IN STAR FIELDS.

When the stars in this region of sky were formed into a constellation by the Frenchman Nicholas Louis de Lacaille it was called Norma et Regula, the square and the ruler. Changes to constellation boundaries saw the stars marking the ruler being reassigned to neighboring Scorpius. One result of this is that present-day Norma has no stars designated Alpha or Beta. The set-square pattern is made of a right-angled trio of stars that is difficult to make out against the Milky Way.



△ **ESO 137-001**
False color highlights two trails of cool gas behind galaxy ESO 137-001. The galaxy is heading toward the center of the Norma Cluster, the closest massive galaxy cluster to the Milky Way. The trails could have formed when gas was stripped from the galaxy's spiral arms.

KEY DATA

Size ranking	74
Brightest stars	Gamma ² (γ ²) 4.0, Epsilon (ε) 4.5
Genitive	Normae
Abbreviation	Nor
Highest in sky at 10pm	June
Fully visible	29°N–90°S



CHART 2

MAIN STARS

Gamma¹ (γ ¹) Normae	
Yellow supergiant, part of a double star with Gamma ²	
☼ 5.0	↔ 1,436 light-years
Gamma² (γ ²) Normae	
Yellow giant, part of a double star with Gamma ¹	
☼ 4.0	↔ 129 light-years
Epsilon (ε) Normae	
Double star with components of 5th and 7th magnitude	
☼ 4.5	↔ 400 light-years
Eta (η) Normae	
Yellow giant star	
☼ 4.7	↔ 218 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 6067	Open cluster
NGC 6087	Open cluster
NGC 6167	Open cluster
Shapley 1	Planetary nebula, also known as the Fine Ring Nebula
Abell 3627	Cluster of galaxies, also known as the Norma Cluster



△ **Shapley 1**
Discovered by Harlow Shapley in 1936, this planetary nebula is a ring of gas seen face-on. In its center is not a single star, but a binary system that cast off the surrounding gas many thousands of years ago. The interaction of the two stars shaped the ejected gas into an almost perfect ring.

